

Phone Usage

1. What day and timeframe did you log what you did on your phone?

I chose to do my experiment today (April 8th). I logged my usage from 9am to 8pm.

2. Rank and categorize your time spent. For example, how much time did you spend shopping, communicating, working, being entertained, scrolling through TikTok, accessing school work, etc.

I spent about 3 and a half hours on my phone according to the Screen Time app. I spent about an hour watching stories and reels on Instagram. I spent about an hour on YouTube, watching videos that showed up on my recommendations page. I spent about 30 minutes with Apple Music open but was listening to music with the app in the background for much longer (Screen Time does not say how long). The rest of my screen time is made up of many other apps that I was using for much shorter amounts of time.

3. What are your own conclusions about your time spent? (two paragraphs)

My typical usage throughout the week is pretty consistent; most of my days have these apps at the top of my screen time. A while ago, I set a limit on my daily Instagram screen time but I rarely reach that limit. When I do reach the limit, I just ignore it, which is a problem because I'm not really controlling myself the way I should.

I find myself using my phone as a distraction from stress and anxiety a lot, especially today. I will have something weighing on my mind, and I will immediately pick up my phone and start aimlessly opening apps and scrolling for no reason just to distract myself from whatever is causing my stress and anxiety. I did this many times today but it would only last for about 30

seconds maximum. I would realize that my stress is not going away, and I put my phone back down and continue whatever I was doing at the moment.

Phone Unplugged

1. What day and timeframe did you unplug from your phone?

I unplugged from 9am to 11am this morning.

2. How did you spend your time when you were unplugged?

I got out of bed soon after waking up, took a shower, and got ready for class without rushing.

3. What are your own conclusions about being unplugged? (two paragraphs)

My mornings are often pretty unproductive. I will wake up and open Instagram to watch reels for a good amount of time. After that, I will get out of bed and shower and get ready for class. I will often get out of the house in a hurry because much of my time was spent on my phone just scrolling.

Unplugging this morning gave me the opportunity to see what a productive and focused morning is like. It showed me what it could be like without the bad habits formed by excessive phone usage after waking up. I got to campus at a very reasonable time and was not stressed out by the risk of being late to my first class.

Overall, what did you learn and how does it connect (or not) with some of the experiences described in "Surviving a Day Without Smartphones"? Also, how does your experience either

substantiate or dispel the argument about the extinction of the smartphone in the article "Why Smartphones Will Become Extinct in 2025"? (two paragraphs)

I learned a good amount from this experience. I generally find my experience and some of the experiences described in "Surviving a Day Without Smartphones" to have many parallels but I do see many differences between the points made in the article "Why Smartphones Will Become Extinct in 2025" and what I see today.

The article "Why Smartphones Will Become Extinct in 2025" states that voice assistants will replace smartphones by 2025. From what I've seen in this experiment, this is very far from reality. Voice assistants are still lacking in many ways, and smartphones are still one of the most used pieces of technology in our everyday lives. The closest AI has come to the claims made in this article is that it is used to tailor content to our preferences so it can populate our feeds for maximum engagement. In this case, it is working alongside our smartphones rather than replacing it.